

INDIGENE

PERSONAL STUDY & BUILD SERIES

GST 102

Communication in English

Complete 12-Week Exam Study Guide + Concord Bonus

Deep Edition — full breakdowns, examples, and 360 trap questions

Prepared for INDIGENE

FULL COURSE OUTLINE

1: COMMUNICATION PROCESS

- Definition of communication
- Elements of communication (Sender, Ideas, Encoding, Channel, Receiver, Decoding, Feedback)
- Purpose of communication
- Types/Forms of communication
- Goals of communication
- Basis for successful/effective communication (Communication Etiquette: Listening, Empathy, Feedback)

2: READING SKILL

- Definition of reading
- Types of reading (Academic, Non-Academic)
- Techniques of reading
- Requirements for reading
- Tips for reading
- Comprehension skill (SQ3R)
- Reading comprehension strategies (Previewing, Predicting, Skimming/Scanning, Guessing from context, Paraphrasing)

3: READING FOR STUDY

- Improving reading skills
- Reading goals (examination, presentation, vocabulary development, academic writing)
- Choosing a text
- Detailed reading and note taking/making
- Outlining
- Developing reading speed

4: TEXT STUDY

- Reading of study text
- Listening to reading of study text
- Speaking/Responding to text reader
- Writing
- Analysis of study text (Character, Characterization, Theme, Literary devices, etc.)

5: LOGIC AND SYLLOGISM IN COMMUNICATION

- Logical thinking and reasoning methods
- Critical thinking and reasoning methods
- Inductive argument and reasoning methods
- Deductive argument and reasoning methods
- Analogy
- Generalization
- Explanations

6: WRITING SKILL

- Definition of writing
- Writing types (Letter writing — Formal, Informal; Memorandum; Article)

7: WRITING SKILL CONT'D

- Report
- Minutes of meeting
- Proposal
- Project
- Curriculum Vitae

WEEK 8: WRITING ETHICS

- Ethical considerations
- Copyright rules and infringements
- Anti-plagiarism rules

- Artificial Intelligence (AI)

WEEK 9: ESSAY WRITING

- Types of essay (Narrative, Argumentative, Descriptive, Expository)
- Strategies for effective writing of each essay type
- Mechanics of writing (Content, Organization, Expression, Mechanical accuracy)

WEEK 10: WRITING ACTIVITIES

- Pre-writing
- Writing
- Post-writing
- Editing
- Proofreading

WEEK 11: ACADEMIC WRITING

- Definition
- Writing style
- Features (Introduction, Formality, Precision, Objectivity, Explicitness, Accuracy and Responsibility)

12: INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY IN MODERN LANGUAGE LEARNING

- Microsoft Office Tools for writing and presentation (MS-Word, MS-Excel, MS-PowerPoint, Corel Draw)
- Social Media Application for Lectures and Assessment (WhatsApp, Telegram, Zoom, Google Meet)
- E-mail (Definition, Etiquette, Composing E-mail, Avoiding wrong/misleading address, Subject crafting, Composing body of e-mail, Complementary closure, Attaching attachments, Formatting e-mails and fonts, Electronic signature, Social Media Content Creation)

13: PARTS OF SPEECH

- Nouns (Proper, Common—Concrete/Abstract, Countable/Uncountable, Collective)
- Pronouns (8 types + Subject/Object table)
- Adjectives (degrees: Base/Comparative/Superlative, regular & irregular)
- Verbs (Lexical vs Auxiliary—Modal/Non-modal, 5 verb forms, Regular vs Irregular, Finite vs Non-finite)
- Adverbs
- Conjunctions (Co-ordinating, Subordinating)
- Prepositions
- Interjections
- Word category shift

14: SENTENCES

- Definition of a sentence
- Independent vs Dependent clauses
- Categorisation by structure (Simple, Compound, Complex, Compound-Complex)
- Categorisation by function (Declarative, Imperative, Exclamatory, Interrogative)

15: COMPREHENSION

- Definition
- Purpose of reading
- What you need to know to understand a passage
- Types of comprehension questions (Open-ended, Multiple Choice)
- Tips for approaching a passage
- Things to avoid while answering

16: REGISTER

- Definition of Register
- Types (Formal, Informal)
- Rules guiding Formal Register

17: THE FULL WRITING PROCESS & ACADEMIC WRITING STYLES

- Purpose of academic writing
- Features of academic writing (expanded)

- Academic Writing Styles (Descriptive, Analytical, Persuasive, Critical)
- Writing process stages (Pre-writing, Gathering Information, Building the Essay Draft)
- What the conclusion should include

18: E-MAIL ETIQUETTE (EXTENDED)

- Definition
- 10-point email etiquette checklist

BONUS: CONCORD (SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT)

- Definition of Concord
- Types of Concord (Grammatical/Formal, Notional, Proximity)
- Core Subject-Verb Agreement Rules (17 rules with examples)

WEEK 1: COMMUNICATION PROCESS

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Communication is like sending a WhatsApp voice note. You (Sender) record your thought (Idea), turn it into audio (Encoding), it travels through WhatsApp's network (Channel), your friend gets it (Receiver), plays and understands it (Decoding), then replies "ok noted" (Feedback). Break any one link — bad network, wrong language, they didn't play the note — and the whole message fails. Communication is never just "talking"; it's a chain, and exam questions love to test which link in the chain broke.

Definition of Communication

- The process of sharing/exchanging information, ideas, thoughts or feelings between a sender and a receiver, using a mutually understood system of signs, symbols, sounds or behaviour, with the aim of being understood.
- It is a two-way, circular process, not a one-way delivery — without feedback flowing back to the sender, you cannot confirm that communication actually succeeded (you only know a message was SENT, not that it was RECEIVED and understood).

Elements of Communication

Element	Function	Everyday example
Sender	Originates and initiates the message	A lecturer starting to teach
Ideas	The actual thought/content to be shared	The topic the lecturer wants to explain
Encoding	Converting the idea into words, symbols, or gestures the receiver can grasp	The lecturer choosing English words and diagrams
Channel	The medium/route the message travels through	Spoken voice in the lecture hall, or a WhatsApp text
Receiver	The person the message is directed at	The student listening
Decoding	The receiver's interpretation of the coded message	The student making sense of the lecturer's words
Feedback	The receiver's response, confirming the message was received/understood	The student nodding, or asking a follow-up question

- Noise/barrier can interrupt the process at any stage — e.g. poor network (channel barrier), unfamiliar vocabulary (encoding/decoding barrier), or distraction (receiver barrier) — which is why real communication always needs feedback to confirm success.

Purpose of Communication

- To inform — pass across facts/knowledge (e.g. news broadcast)
- To persuade — convince someone to believe or act (e.g. an advert, a campaign speech)
- To educate — build knowledge/skill over time (e.g. a lecture)
- To entertain — amuse or engage emotionally (e.g. a comedy skit)
- To express emotion — share feelings (e.g. a condolence message)

- To build relationships and coordinate action — keep people connected and working together (e.g. a group project chat)

Types / Forms of Communication

- By code: Verbal (spoken/written words) and Non-verbal (body language, gestures, facial expression, tone, posture, eye contact)
- By scope: Intrapersonal (communication within oneself, e.g. self-talk/thinking), Interpersonal (between two or more individuals), Group (within a defined group), and Mass/Public communication (to a large, often anonymous audience, e.g. TV/radio)
- By channel: Visual, Audio, Audio-visual, and Written communication

Goals of Communication

- Clarity — the message is easy to understand, not vague or confusing
- Accuracy — the information shared is correct and true to the sender's intent
- Mutual understanding — both sender and receiver interpret the message the same way
- Eliciting the intended response/action — the receiver does/feels/believes what the sender aimed for

Basis for Successful / Effective Communication

- Communication Etiquette — the unwritten rules that keep an exchange respectful and productive:
 - Listening — giving full, undistracted attention before responding, not just waiting for your turn to talk
 - Empathy — genuinely understanding the other party's feelings/perspective before reacting
 - Feedback — confirming, clearly and promptly, that the message landed as intended

EXAM HACK

Memorise the 7 elements with “**S-I-E-C-R-D-F**” (Sender → Idea → Encode → Channel → Receiver → Decode → Feedback). In scenario questions (“What element failed/is missing?”), match the scenario to exactly one of these 7 steps — examiners almost always test Encoding vs Decoding confusion, so know the difference: Encoding = sender packages the idea; Decoding = receiver unpacks it.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What are the two elements involved BEFORE encoding happens? (*Ans: Sender and Ideas*)
2. Which element proves communication was actually understood, not just sent? (*Ans: Feedback*)
3. Encoding is done by the ____, decoding is done by the _____. (*Ans: sender; receiver*)
4. Radio, WhatsApp, and speech are all examples of which element? (*Ans: Channel*)
5. Is communication a one-way or two-way process? (*Ans: Two-way (circular)*)
6. If a teacher speaks but no student responds, has feedback occurred? (*Ans: No*)
7. Convincing someone to buy a product is which purpose of communication? (*Ans: To persuade*)
8. A TV news broadcast is an example of which scope of communication? (*Ans: Mass/Public communication*)
9. Talking to yourself while thinking is which scope of communication? (*Ans: Intrapersonal*)
10. Facial expression and gestures fall under which code of communication? (*Ans: Non-verbal*)
11. Name the three components of Communication Etiquette. (*Ans: Listening, Empathy, Feedback*)
12. A bad network interrupting a call is a barrier at which element? (*Ans: Channel*)
13. Using unfamiliar vocabulary a receiver can't understand is a barrier at which stage? (*Ans: Encoding/Decoding*)
14. Clarity, Accuracy, Mutual understanding, and eliciting response are all examples of what? (*Ans: Goals of communication*)
15. A condolence message mainly serves which purpose? (*Ans: To express emotion*)
16. True or False: Communication can be considered successful without feedback. (*Ans: False*)
17. Which element is the raw, unpackaged thought before it becomes words? (*Ans: Ideas*)
18. Two friends chatting is an example of which scope of communication? (*Ans: Interpersonal*)
19. Understanding a classmate's frustration before responding is an example of what? (*Ans: Empathy*)
20. In S-I-E-C-R-D-F, which letter comes immediately after Channel? (*Ans: R (Receiver)*)

WEEK 2: READING SKILL

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Reading is like eating — sometimes you're grabbing a quick snack (skimming a WhatsApp status), and sometimes you're eating a full plate of rice slowly to actually enjoy and digest it (detailed academic reading). Using the wrong "speed" for the wrong meal either wastes your time or leaves you hungry (under-prepared) — matching technique to purpose is the whole skill.

Definition of Reading

- The cognitive process of decoding written symbols to construct meaning and understanding from a text.
- It is active, not passive — the reader is constantly predicting, questioning, and connecting new information to what they already know, not just moving their eyes across the page.

Types of Reading

- Academic reading — textbooks, journals, lecture materials; done deliberately, for study/exams; usually slower and more analytical
- Non-Academic reading — newspapers, novels, social media; done for leisure/general information; usually faster and less analytical

Techniques of Reading

Technique	What it is	When to use it
Skimming	Reading fast for the general idea/gist only	Deciding if a source is even worth reading fully
Scanning	Searching fast for one specific fact/word	Finding a date, name, or figure quickly
Intensive/Detailed reading	Slow, careful reading for full, deep understanding	Studying for an exam
Extensive reading	Reading widely across many texts for fluency/exposure	Building vocabulary and general knowledge over time

Requirements for Reading

- A clear reading goal (know WHY you're reading before you start)
- Adequate vocabulary to decode the words used
- Concentration/focus, free from distraction
- A suitable, quiet environment
- Background knowledge of the topic, which helps you predict and interpret faster

Tips for Reading

- Set a purpose before you start reading
- Preview the text first (titles, headings, first/last paragraphs) to get a mental map
- Avoid subvocalising — silently pronouncing every word in your head — as it slows you down to speaking speed
- Take short breaks to retain focus over long study sessions
- Review/summarise what you read afterward, in your own words, to lock it into memory

Comprehension Skill — SQ3R

Step	What it means	In practice
Survey	Preview the text — headings, subheadings, summaries	Flip through the chapter before reading it properly
Question	Turn headings into questions you expect the text to answer	"What IS SQ3R?" from the heading "SQ3R"
Read	Read actively, looking for answers to your own questions	Reading with a pen, underlining answers as you find them
Recite	Recall/say the answers in your own words without looking	Closing the book and explaining it out loud
Review	Go back over the material to consolidate memory	Re-reading your notes a day later

Reading Comprehension Strategies

- Previewing — scanning the text's structure before reading properly, to know what to expect
- Predicting — guessing what comes next based on context/title/headings
- Skimming/Scanning — covered above under Techniques
- Guessing from context — deducing an unfamiliar word's meaning from the surrounding sentence, without a dictionary
- Paraphrasing — restating what was read in your own words, which is the surest test that you actually understood it

EXAM HACK

SQ3R spells like a survival code: **S**urvey **Q**uestion **R**ead **R**ecite **R**evue — "SQ then 3 R's." In exams, if you're asked to "name the comprehension technique used in the passage," check for context clues (unfamiliar word explained nearby) = Guessing from Context; restated idea in simpler words = Paraphrasing; reading titles/headings before the main text = Previewing, not Skimming (Skimming reads the BODY fast, Previewing looks at STRUCTURE only).

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Reading a novel for fun is which type of reading? (Ans: *Non-Academic*)
2. Which technique is used to quickly find one date in a long article? (Ans: *Scanning*)
3. Which technique gives you only the general gist of a passage? (Ans: *Skimming*)
4. What is it called when you silently pronounce every word as you read? (Ans: *Subvocalising*)
5. What effect does subvocalising have on reading speed? (Ans: *Slows it down*)
6. Reading widely across many novels to build vocabulary is which type of reading technique? (Ans: *Extensive reading*)
7. What are the 5 steps of SQ3R, in order? (Ans: *Survey, Question, Read, Recite, Review*)
8. Turning a heading into a question happens at which SQ3R stage? (Ans: *Question*)
9. Explaining what you read out loud, without looking at the text, is which SQ3R stage? (Ans: *Recite*)
10. Guessing an unfamiliar word's meaning from nearby sentences is called what? (Ans: *Guessing from context*)
11. Restating a passage in your own words is called what? (Ans: *Paraphrasing*)
12. Which comprehension strategy involves looking only at structure before reading fully? (Ans: *Previewing*)
13. Name 3 requirements for effective reading. (Ans: *Any 3 of: clear goal, vocabulary, concentration, quiet environment, background knowledge*)
14. Studying a textbook chapter slowly for an exam is which type of reading? (Ans: *Intensive/detailed academic reading*)
15. True or False: Skimming and Previewing are exactly the same thing. (Ans: *False*)
16. What should you do BEFORE you start reading, according to reading tips? (Ans: *Set a purpose*)
17. What should you do AFTER reading, to lock information in memory? (Ans: *Review/summarise in your own words*)
18. Reading a news app on your phone for updates is which type of reading? (Ans: *Non-Academic*)
19. Which SQ3R step comes immediately before Recite? (Ans: *Read*)
20. Predicting what comes next in a passage based on its title is which strategy? (Ans: *Predicting*)

WEEK 3: READING FOR STUDY

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Reading for study is like preparing for a market trip with a shopping list. You don't just wander the market (random reading) — you go in with a goal (reading goal), pick only the stalls you need (choosing a text), note prices as you go (note-taking), reorganise your list at home (note-making/outlining), and walk faster on your way back once you know the route (developing reading speed).

Improving Reading Skills

- Reading skill is improved through regular, deliberate practice combined with ACTIVE engagement — questioning the text, taking notes, summarising — rather than passive scanning of the page.

Reading Goals

Goal	Focus
For examination	Targeted, detailed reading of the material most likely to be tested
For presentation	Reading to extract key points that can be relayed clearly to an audience
For vocabulary development	Reading widely to build a bigger word bank
For academic writing	Reading to gather evidence, arguments, and references to support your own writing

Choosing a Text

- Relevance — does it actually match your purpose/topic?
- Credibility — is the source/author reliable and reputable?
- Currency — how recent/up to date is the information?
- Reading level — does it match your own vocabulary and comprehension level?

Detailed Reading and Note Taking/Making

- Note-taking — jotting down key points AS you read, often in rough, shorthand form, capturing raw information quickly
- Note-making — reorganising those raw notes AFTER reading into a structured, clearer, study-ready format

Outlining

- Structuring the main ideas and sub-ideas of a text in a hierarchical (point and sub-point) format, so the relationship between a big idea and its supporting details is visually clear — similar to how this very study guide is organised into headings and bullet points.

Developing Reading Speed

- Avoiding subvocalisation (see Week 2)
- Reducing regression — the habit of going back to re-read the same line/word unnecessarily
- Widening eye span — taking in groups of words at once instead of one word at a time
- Practising timed reading regularly to build pace without losing comprehension

EXAM HACK

Trap alert: "Note-taking" and "Note-making" are commonly swapped in MCQs. Fix it with: **Note-TAKING = DURING** reading (raw/rough); **Note-MAKING = AFTER** reading (refined/organised). "Taking" happens while it's happening; "making" happens once you sit down to build something from it.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Which happens DURING reading: note-taking or note-making? (Ans: Note-taking)
2. Which happens AFTER reading, to organise raw notes? (Ans: Note-making)
3. Re-reading the same line unnecessarily while reading is called what? (Ans: Regression)
4. What is it called when you take in groups of words at once instead of one at a time? (Ans: Widening eye span)
5. Reading to gather evidence for an essay serves which reading goal? (Ans: For academic writing)
6. Name the 4 factors used when choosing a text. (Ans: Relevance, credibility, currency, reading level)
7. Currency, when choosing a text, refers to what? (Ans: How recent/up to date the information is)
8. Structuring main ideas and sub-ideas hierarchically is called what? (Ans: Outlining)
9. Reading detailed material specifically likely to be tested serves which reading goal? (Ans: For examination)
10. True or False: Improving reading skill only requires reading more, regardless of engagement. (Ans: False (needs active engagement))
11. Which skill-development technique directly opposes subvocalisation? (Ans: None directly — avoiding subvocalisation IS the technique)
12. Extracting key points to relay to an audience serves which reading goal? (Ans: For presentation)
13. Is credibility about the author/source, or about the length of the text? (Ans: The author/source)
14. What replaces raw, rough notes once you sit down after reading? (Ans: Organised/refined notes (note-making))
15. Reducing regression and widening eye span both aim to improve what? (Ans: Reading speed)
16. Building a bigger word bank matches which reading goal? (Ans: For vocabulary development)
17. True or False: Outlining shows ideas as a flat, unordered list. (Ans: False (it's hierarchical))
18. A text that is outdated fails which text-selection criterion? (Ans: Currency)
19. A text too advanced for the reader fails which criterion? (Ans: Reading level)
20. What is the main difference in FORM between note-taking and note-making output? (Ans: Note-taking is rough/raw; note-making is structured/organised)

WEEK 4: TEXT STUDY

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Studying a text is like watching a Nollywood movie critically instead of just for entertainment: you notice who the actors are and how they act (Character/Characterisation), what lesson the movie is teaching (Theme), and the director's tricks — flashbacks, symbolism, suspense — that make the story hit different (Literary devices). You engage the movie by watching it, discussing it with friends, and maybe writing a review — exactly like the four modes of engaging a study text below.

Modes of Engaging a Study Text

- Reading of study text — the learner reads the text personally, silently or aloud
- Listening to reading of study text — the learner listens as the text is read aloud by someone else (a teacher, an audiobook)
- Speaking/Responding to text reader — the learner discusses, answers, or reacts verbally to the text/reader
- Writing — the learner produces written analyses, summaries, or personal responses based on the text

Analysis of Study Text

Element	Meaning
Character	The individual persons/entities/animals that act within the story
Characterisation	The TECHNIQUES the writer uses to reveal a character's personality — through their speech, actions, appearance, thoughts, and how other characters react to them
Theme	The central message, lesson, or underlying idea running through the text (e.g. love, betrayal, greed, resilience)
Literary devices	Techniques such as symbolism, imagery, irony, foreshadowing, metaphor, simile, and setting, used by the writer to deepen meaning and effect

- A character can be major (central to the plot) or minor (supporting); round (fully developed, complex) or flat (one-dimensional); dynamic (changes over the story) or static (stays the same).
- Characterisation can be direct (the writer states the trait outright, e.g. "She was kind") or indirect (the trait is shown through action/dialogue, and the reader must infer it).

EXAM HACK

Distinguish Character vs Characterisation fast: **Character = WHO** is in the story; **Characterisation = HOW** we come to know who they are. If a question describes a "method" (e.g. "through dialogue, the writer shows..."), the answer is Characterisation, not Character. Also: "She was kind" = DIRECT characterisation; "She gave her last coin to a beggar" = INDIRECT.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. WHO is in a story refers to which literary element? (Ans: *Character*)
2. HOW we learn about a character refers to which literary element? (Ans: *Characterisation*)
3. The central message/lesson of a text is called what? (Ans: *Theme*)
4. Symbolism, irony, and foreshadowing are examples of what? (Ans: *Literary devices*)
5. "She was kind" is an example of which type of characterisation? (Ans: *Direct*)
6. "She gave her last coin to a beggar" is an example of which type of characterisation? (Ans: *Indirect*)
7. A character central to the plot is called a ____ character. (Ans: *Major*)
8. A character who does not change throughout the story is called _____. (Ans: *Static*)
9. A character who changes over the course of the story is called _____. (Ans: *Dynamic*)
10. A one-dimensional, simple character is described as _____. (Ans: *Flat*)
11. A fully developed, complex character is described as _____. (Ans: *Round*)
12. Listening to an audiobook is which mode of engaging a study text? (Ans: *Listening to reading of study text*)
13. Writing a summary of a novel is which mode of engaging a study text? (Ans: *Writing*)
14. Discussing a text's meaning aloud with a teacher is which mode? (Ans: *Speaking/Responding to text reader*)
15. Name the 4 modes of engaging a study text. (Ans: *Reading, Listening, Speaking/Responding, Writing*)
16. A writer using a storm to represent conflict is an example of which literary device? (Ans: *Symbolism*)
17. Saying the opposite of what is meant, for effect, is which literary device? (Ans: *Irony*)
18. Hints early in a story about what will happen later is called what? (Ans: *Foreshadowing*)
19. True or False: Theme and Character mean the same thing. (Ans: *False*)
20. Is Characterisation about WHO the character is, or the METHOD of revealing them? (Ans: *The method of revealing them*)

WEEK 5: LOGIC AND SYLLOGISM IN COMMUNICATION

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Logic in communication is like a lawyer building a case in court. She doesn't just say "trust me" — she lays down solid facts (premises) that FORCE the judge to arrive at one conclusion. Deductive reasoning is an airtight case (certain, if the facts are true); inductive reasoning is more like a detective's best guess from limited clues (probable, but could still be wrong).

Logical & Critical Thinking (for meaningful presentation)

- Logical thinking — reasoning in a structured, step-by-step, valid manner, where each point follows sensibly from the one before it
- Critical thinking — objectively analysing, evaluating, and questioning information/arguments before accepting them, rather than believing everything at face value

Inductive Argument and Reasoning

- Moves from SPECIFIC observations to a GENERAL conclusion; the conclusion is only probable, not guaranteed, even if all the observed premises are true.
- Example: "Every swan I have seen is white, therefore all swans are white" — later disproved when black swans were discovered in Australia. The reasoning felt strong, but the conclusion turned out false.

Deductive Argument and Reasoning

- Moves from GENERAL premises to a SPECIFIC, certain conclusion; if the premises are true and the logical FORM is valid, the conclusion MUST be true — there is no room for exception.
- Classic syllogism (3-part structure): All men are mortal (major premise, general rule); Socrates is a man (minor premise, specific case); therefore Socrates is mortal (conclusion, logically forced).

Analogy

- Reasoning that draws a comparison between two similar things to explain or argue a point ("X is like Y, therefore..."). Every "Alzheimer's Mode" box in this guide is itself an analogy.

Generalization

- Forming a broad conclusion or rule based on a limited number of specific instances/examples — closely related to inductive reasoning, and carries the same risk of being wrong if the sample is too small or unrepresentative.

Explanations

- Statements that clarify WHY or HOW something is the case, aimed at understanding rather than persuading someone to a conclusion.

EXAM HACK

Trap: exams love to swap "Inductive" and "Deductive." Fix with: **de-DUCE** = general → specific, guaranteed/certain conclusion. **IN-duction** = specific instances → general rule, only PROBABLE. If the question's conclusion COULD still be proven wrong later by a new example, it's Inductive.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Which reasoning type moves from general to specific? (Ans: *Deductive*)
2. Which reasoning type moves from specific to general? (Ans: *Inductive*)
3. Which reasoning type gives a certain, guaranteed conclusion (if premises are true)? (Ans: *Deductive*)
4. Which reasoning type gives only a probable conclusion? (Ans: *Inductive*)
5. "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; therefore Socrates is mortal" is an example of what? (Ans: *Deductive reasoning/syllogism*)
6. "Every swan I've seen is white, so all swans are white" is an example of what? (Ans: *Inductive reasoning*)
7. A syllogism has how many parts/premises? (Ans: *Three (major premise, minor premise, conclusion)*)
8. What is the general rule in a syllogism called? (Ans: *The major premise*)
9. What is the specific case in a syllogism called? (Ans: *The minor premise*)
10. Comparing two similar things to explain a point is called what? (Ans: *Analogy*)
11. Forming a broad rule from a few examples is called what? (Ans: *Generalization*)
12. A statement clarifying WHY something happens, without trying to persuade, is called what? (Ans: *An explanation*)
13. Objectively questioning information before accepting it is called what? (Ans: *Critical thinking*)
14. Reasoning step-by-step in a structured, valid way is called what? (Ans: *Logical thinking*)
15. True or False: A deductive conclusion can be false even if the form is valid and premises are true. (Ans: *False*)
16. True or False: An inductive conclusion can still turn out to be false. (Ans: *True*)
17. Which is riskier for guaranteeing truth: induction or deduction? (Ans: *Induction*)
18. An Alzheimer's Mode analogy in this guide is an example of which reasoning tool? (Ans: *Analogy*)
19. Generalization is most closely related to which reasoning type? (Ans: *Inductive reasoning*)
20. If the sample size behind a generalization is too small, what risk increases? (Ans: *The conclusion being wrong/unrepresentative*)

WEEK 6: WRITING SKILL

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Writing skill is like having different outfits for different occasions. You don't wear the same thing to a wedding (formal letter) as you would to hang out with friends (informal letter) — each writing type has its own “dress code” of tone, structure, and language, and wearing the wrong outfit (wrong format) to the wrong occasion is exactly the kind of mistake exam questions test.

Definition of Writing

- The graphic representation of language through symbols/letters to communicate ideas in a durable, recorded form — unlike speech, writing can be stored, revisited, and referenced later exactly as it was first produced.

Writing Types

Type	Key features
Letter Writing — Formal	Business/official tone; sender's address, date, recipient's address, salutation (Dear Sir/Madam), subject heading, formal closing (Yours faithfully/sincerely)
Letter Writing — Informal	Personal/casual tone; used for family/friends; relaxed structure and closing (e.g. “Yours truly”, “Love”)
Memorandum (Memo)	Internal communication within an organisation; header block (To/From/Date/Subject), concise, no salutation/complimentary close
Article	Written for publication (magazine/journal/newspaper); has a catchy title, byline, and structured body aimed at informing/persuading a wide readership

WRITING SKILL CONT'D (Week 7)

Type	Key features
Report	Factual, organised account of an event/investigation/findings; usually has title, introduction, findings, and recommendations
Minutes of Meeting	Official written record of what was discussed and decided at a meeting; includes attendance, agenda items, decisions, and action points
Proposal	A persuasive document suggesting a plan/project for approval; states the problem, objectives, methodology, and expected benefits
Project	An extended, structured academic write-up on a chosen topic, following a formal research format (introduction, literature review, methodology, findings, conclusion)
Curriculum Vitae (CV)	A summary of a person's education, skills, and experience, used when applying for jobs/opportunities

EXAM HACK

For “identify the writing type from the excerpt” questions: no salutation + header block (To/From/Date) = Memo. Salutation + address block + “Yours faithfully” = Formal Letter. Attendance list + agenda + decisions = Minutes. “We recommend approval of...” = Proposal. Chapters/methodology/literature review = Project. “Objective: To apply for the position of...” = CV.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Which writing type has NO salutation and NO complimentary close? (Ans: *Memorandum (Memo)*)
2. Which writing type ends with “Yours faithfully”? (Ans: *Formal letter*)
3. Which writing type records attendance, agenda, and decisions from a meeting? (Ans: *Minutes of Meeting*)
4. Which document persuades someone to approve a plan or project? (Ans: *Proposal*)
5. Which document summarises a person's education and work experience? (Ans: *Curriculum Vitae (CV)*)
6. Which writing type follows a full research format — literature review, methodology, findings? (Ans: *Project*)
7. Which writing type is written specifically for magazine/newspaper publication? (Ans: *Article*)
8. A memo is used for communication within, or outside, an organisation? (Ans: *Within (internal)*)
9. Which letter type uses a relaxed tone and closings like “Love”? (Ans: *Informal letter*)
10. What 4 header items appear at the top of a memo? (Ans: *To, From, Date, Subject*)
11. What is the purpose of a Report? (Ans: *To give a factual, organised account of an event/investigation/findings*)
12. Does a report typically end with recommendations? (Ans: *Yes*)
13. Which document format would list “Objectives” and “Expected benefits”? (Ans: *Proposal*)
14. Which of the writing types is best suited to informing a wide public readership? (Ans: *Article*)
15. What replaces a salutation at the start of a memo? (Ans: *The header block (To/From/Date/Subject)*)
16. Which document type is used when applying for a job? (Ans: *Curriculum Vitae (CV)*)
17. True or False: A formal letter and an informal letter use the same closing style. (Ans: *False*)
18. Attendance list is a required feature of which document? (Ans: *Minutes of Meeting*)
19. Which writing type is the most extended and academic in structure? (Ans: *Project*)
20. A subject heading appears in which writing type(s)? (Ans: *Formal letter and memo*)

WEEK 8: WRITING ETHICS

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Writing ethics is like borrowing your friend's textbook: you can read it and even quote from it, but you must give it back and tell people it's theirs (citation), not tear out pages and claim you wrote the book (plagiarism). Using AI tools follows the same logic — you can get help, but you can't pass off unverified, unacknowledged AI output as fully your own original work.

Ethical Considerations

- Honesty — not fabricating facts, sources, or results
- Originality — producing your own genuine ideas/work
- Accuracy — ensuring information presented is correct
- Giving proper credit to sources whenever you use someone else's ideas/words in academic or professional writing

Copyright Rules and Infringements

- Copyright — the legal right of an author/creator to control the reproduction, distribution, and use of their original work
- Infringement — using, copying, or distributing a copyrighted work without the owner's permission; this is a LEGAL matter, and can lead to legal penalties

Anti-Plagiarism Rules

- Plagiarism — presenting another person's work/ideas as your own without acknowledgement; this is an ACADEMIC INTEGRITY matter
- Avoided through: proper citation/referencing of sources, paraphrasing in your own words (not just changing a few words), and using quotation marks for any direct quotes

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

- Ethical use of AI tools in writing requires: disclosing/acknowledging AI assistance where required, verifying AI-generated content for accuracy (AI can be confidently wrong), and not presenting AI output as fully original human work without appropriate review and personal input.

EXAM HACK

Quick definitions trap: **Copyright infringement** = using someone's PROTECTED WORK without permission (a LEGAL issue). **Plagiarism** = failing to CREDIT the source of ideas/words (an ACADEMIC INTEGRITY issue) — you can plagiarise a work that is not even copyrighted (e.g. something in the public domain), so the two overlap but are NOT identical.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Is copyright infringement a legal issue or an academic integrity issue? *(Ans: Legal issue)*
2. Is plagiarism a legal issue or an academic integrity issue? *(Ans: Academic integrity issue)*
3. Can you plagiarise a work that is not copyrighted? *(Ans: Yes)*
4. What legal right does copyright give a creator? *(Ans: The right to control reproduction/use/distribution of their work)*
5. Name 3 ways to avoid plagiarism. *(Ans: Any 3 of: citation/referencing, paraphrasing properly, using quotation marks for direct quotes)*
6. Is changing just a few words of a source considered proper paraphrasing? *(Ans: No)*
7. What symbol/mark should surround a direct quote from a source? *(Ans: Quotation marks)*
8. What must you do before presenting AI-generated content as accurate? *(Ans: Verify it for accuracy)*
9. Fabricating results in a report violates which ethical consideration? *(Ans: Honesty)*
10. Copying another student's essay word for word without credit is called what? *(Ans: Plagiarism)*
11. Reproducing a copyrighted textbook without permission and selling it is called what? *(Ans: Copyright infringement)*
12. Name the 4 core ethical considerations in writing. *(Ans: Honesty, originality, accuracy, giving proper credit)*
13. True or False: AI-generated content should be presented as fully original without review. *(Ans: False)*
14. What must be disclosed when AI assistance is used in writing, where required? *(Ans: That AI was used/the AI assistance itself)*
15. Does citing a source properly protect you from a plagiarism accusation? *(Ans: Yes)*
16. Which is broader in scope — plagiarism or copyright infringement? *(Ans: Plagiarism (can apply even without copyright))*
17. What consequence typically follows copyright infringement, being a legal matter? *(Ans: Legal penalties)*
18. Presenting your own genuine ideas, not copied, reflects which ethical consideration? *(Ans: Originality)*
19. What is the risk of accepting AI output without verification? *(Ans: It may be inaccurate/wrong despite sounding confident)*
20. Failing to acknowledge a source's ideas, even if paraphrased, is still what? *(Ans: Plagiarism)*

WEEK 9: ESSAY WRITING

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Essay types are like different reasons to talk to a friend: telling them a story (Narrative), convincing them your side is right (Argumentative), painting a picture with words so they can “see” it (Descriptive), or just explaining how something works (Expository). Mixing up WHY you're writing with HOW you write it is the most common essay mistake students make.

Types of Essay

Type	Purpose	Tell-tale sign
Narrative	Tells a story with a plot, characters, and sequence of events	Has a beginning-middle-end plot
Argumentative	Presents a claim and defends it with evidence/reasoning, addressing counterarguments	Uses phrases like “I argue/believe that...”
Descriptive	Creates a vivid picture of a person, place, object, or experience using sensory detail	Heavy use of adjectives, sensory language
Expository	Explains, informs, or clarifies a topic/process clearly, factually, and logically	States facts/steps, no personal opinion

Strategies for Effective Writing of Each Essay Type

- Narrative — use chronological order, vivid characters, and a clear conflict/resolution
- Argumentative — state a clear thesis, support with evidence, and directly address the opposing view
- Descriptive — use sensory/figurative language (sight, sound, smell, touch, taste) and specific, concrete detail rather than vague description
- Expository — organise logically (cause-effect, compare-contrast, chronological order) and stay strictly objective, avoiding personal opinion

Mechanics of Writing

Element	Meaning
Content	The ideas/information the essay actually contains — its relevance, depth, and quality of thought
Organization	The logical structure/flow of the essay — introduction, body, conclusion, and paragraphing
Expression	The clarity and appropriateness of the language/style used to convey the content
Mechanical Accuracy	Correctness of grammar, spelling, punctuation, and sentence structure

EXAM HACK

Fast ID trick for essay type: story with characters/plot = Narrative; "I believe/argue that..." with evidence and a counter-view addressed = Argumentative; lots of adjectives/sensory words, no real plot = Descriptive; steps/facts/how-something-works with zero opinion = Expository. If "Mechanics of Writing" is asked, remember: **C.O.E.M** — Content, Organization, Expression, Mechanical accuracy.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Which essay type tells a story with a plot? (*Ans: Narrative*)
2. Which essay type defends a claim with evidence? (*Ans: Argumentative*)
3. Which essay type uses vivid sensory language to paint a picture? (*Ans: Descriptive*)
4. Which essay type explains a process factually, with no opinion? (*Ans: Expository*)
5. An essay that addresses a counterargument is most likely which type? (*Ans: Argumentative*)
6. An essay heavy in adjectives describing a sunset is most likely which type? (*Ans: Descriptive*)
7. An essay explaining "how photosynthesis works" is which type? (*Ans: Expository*)
8. Name the 4 elements of the Mechanics of Writing. (*Ans: Content, Organization, Expression, Mechanical accuracy*)
9. Grammar, spelling, and punctuation correctness falls under which mechanic? (*Ans: Mechanical accuracy*)
10. The logical flow of intro-body-conclusion falls under which mechanic? (*Ans: Organization*)
11. The actual ideas/information in the essay fall under which mechanic? (*Ans: Content*)
12. Clarity and appropriateness of language/style fall under which mechanic? (*Ans: Expression*)
13. Which essay strategy calls for chronological order and a conflict/resolution? (*Ans: Narrative strategy*)
14. Which essay strategy calls for a clear thesis and addressing opposing views? (*Ans: Argumentative strategy*)
15. Which essay strategy calls for cause-effect or compare-contrast organisation? (*Ans: Expository strategy*)
16. Which essay strategy calls for concrete, sensory detail rather than vague description? (*Ans: Descriptive strategy*)
17. True or False: A Descriptive essay should focus mainly on presenting an argument. (*Ans: False*)
18. True or False: An Expository essay should include the writer's personal opinion. (*Ans: False*)
19. What does C.O.E.M stand for? (*Ans: Content, Organization, Expression, Mechanical accuracy*)
20. A well-organised paragraph structure relates most to which mechanic? (*Ans: Organization*)

WEEK 10: WRITING ACTIVITIES

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Writing is a full cooking process, not just “cooking.” You plan the meal (pre-writing), cook it (writing), taste and adjust seasoning as a whole dish (post-writing), fine-tune specific ingredients (editing), and finally wipe the plate clean before serving (proofreading) — skip a step and the meal (essay) suffers, no matter how good your cooking (ideas) were.

The Writing Process

Stage	What happens
Pre-writing	Planning — brainstorming, choosing a topic, gathering ideas, outlining, before any full sentence is written
Writing	Producing the first full draft based on the plan, focusing on getting ideas down rather than perfection
Post-writing	Reviewing the draft for content, structure, and clarity AS A WHOLE — does the essay make sense overall?
Editing	Revising for grammar, word choice, sentence structure, and coherence at a more DETAILED level than post-writing
Proofreading	The FINAL check for surface errors — spelling, punctuation, typos — right before submission

EXAM HACK

Editing vs Proofreading trap: **Editing** happens EARLIER and deals with BIGGER issues (structure, clarity, word choice, coherence). **Proofreading** happens LAST and catches SMALL surface errors (typos, spelling, punctuation). Remember: “Edit the meaning, Proof the surface.” Order to memorise: Pre-writing → Writing → Post-writing → Editing → Proofreading.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What is the very first stage of the writing process? (Ans: *Pre-writing*)
2. What is the very last stage of the writing process? (Ans: *Proofreading*)
3. Brainstorming and outlining happen at which stage? (Ans: *Pre-writing*)
4. Producing the first full draft happens at which stage? (Ans: *Writing*)
5. Which stage deals with bigger issues like structure and coherence? (Ans: *Editing*)
6. Which stage catches small surface errors like typos and spelling? (Ans: *Proofreading*)
7. Which comes first: Editing or Proofreading? (Ans: *Editing*)
8. Reviewing a draft as a whole for overall sense happens at which stage? (Ans: *Post-writing*)
9. List the 5 stages of the writing process in order. (Ans: *Pre-writing, Writing, Post-writing, Editing, Proofreading*)
10. True or False: Proofreading should happen before Editing. (Ans: *False*)
11. Which stage focuses on getting ideas down rather than perfection? (Ans: *Writing*)
12. Checking punctuation right before submission is which stage? (Ans: *Proofreading*)
13. Revising word choice and sentence structure is which stage? (Ans: *Editing*)
14. What memory phrase captures Editing vs Proofreading? (Ans: *Edit the meaning, Proof the surface*)
15. Choosing a topic before writing any sentences happens at which stage? (Ans: *Pre-writing*)
16. Which stage is more detailed — Post-writing or Editing? (Ans: *Editing*)
17. Does Pre-writing include full sentence writing? (Ans: *No*)
18. Which stage would catch a spelling mistake missed during Editing? (Ans: *Proofreading*)
19. Which stage would catch a confusing paragraph structure? (Ans: *Editing (or Post-writing)*)
20. How many total stages make up the writing process? (Ans: *Five*)

WEEK 11: ACADEMIC WRITING

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Academic writing is like appearing before a panel of professors: you can't be casual ("lol", slang), you must be exact (Precision) and back up every claim with evidence (Objectivity), and you can't just say "I feel like it's true" — you show the proof and take responsibility for it being correct (Accuracy and Responsibility).

Definition

- A formal, evidence-based style of writing used in scholarly/academic contexts to present research, arguments, or analysis clearly and objectively.

Writing Style

- Structured, impersonal, evidence-driven, and governed by discipline-specific conventions and referencing styles (e.g. APA, MLA) — personal opinion and casual language are avoided unless explicitly framed as part of an argument backed by evidence.

Features of Academic Writing

Feature	What it means	What breaks it
Introduction	Sets out the purpose, scope, and structure of the piece	No clear roadmap for the reader
Formality	Avoids slang, contractions, and casual/conversational language	Using "can't", "lol", or chatty tone
Precision	Uses exact, specific words rather than vague general terms	Saying "a lot of" instead of an exact figure
Objectivity	Focuses on evidence and facts rather than personal opinion/emotion	"I feel that..." without evidence
Explicitness	Clearly signals the structure and logic of the argument to the reader	Jumping between ideas with no linking/signposting
Accuracy and Responsibility	Ensures claims are correct, properly sourced, and the writer owns the content	Unverified or unsourced claims

EXAM HACK

6 features, one sentence: "I Formally Prove Objective Explicit Accuracy" = Introduction, **F**ormality, **P**recision, **O**bjectivity, **E**xplicitness, **A**ccuracy & Responsibility. If an exam option uses slang/contractions or personal opinion as "academic," it's automatically wrong — that breaks Formality/Objectivity.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Name the 6 features of academic writing. (*Ans: Introduction, Formality, Precision, Objectivity, Explicitness, Accuracy and Responsibility*)
2. Which feature is broken by using slang or contractions? (*Ans: Formality*)
3. Which feature is broken by unsupported personal opinion? (*Ans: Objectivity*)
4. Which feature is broken by vague terms like "a lot of"? (*Ans: Precision*)
5. Which feature sets out the purpose and scope at the start of a piece? (*Ans: Introduction*)
6. Which feature ensures claims are correctly sourced and owned by the writer? (*Ans: Accuracy and Responsibility*)
7. Which feature involves clearly signalling the logic/structure to the reader? (*Ans: Explicitness*)
8. Is academic writing personal/casual or impersonal/formal in style? (*Ans: Impersonal/formal*)
9. What memory sentence captures all 6 features? (*Ans: "I Formally Prove Objective Explicit Accuracy"*)
10. True or False: Academic writing welcomes emotional, opinion-based claims without evidence. (*Ans: False*)
11. What kind of style/referencing conventions govern academic writing? (*Ans: Discipline-specific conventions and referencing styles (e.g. APA, MLA)*)
12. Is academic writing evidence-based or belief-based? (*Ans: Evidence-based*)
13. Using "can't" instead of "cannot" in an essay breaks which feature? (*Ans: Formality*)
14. An unsourced statistic in an essay breaks which feature? (*Ans: Accuracy and Responsibility*)
15. A confusing essay with no linking words between ideas breaks which feature? (*Ans: Explicitness*)
16. Does academic writing allow chatty, conversational tone? (*Ans: No*)
17. Which feature focuses specifically on exact wording over vague terms? (*Ans: Precision*)
18. Does academic writing style change across academic disciplines? (*Ans: Yes (discipline-specific conventions)*)
19. Is academic writing generally personal in voice (using "I feel" heavily)? (*Ans: No*)
20. Which feature is most directly about presenting facts instead of feelings? (*Ans: Objectivity*)

WEEK 12: INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY IN MODERN LANGUAGE LEARNING

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

*This week is basically “your phone/laptop as a communication toolbox.”
MS-Word/Excel/PowerPoint/CorelDraw are your writing and design tools;
WhatsApp/Telegram/Zoom/Google Meet are your classroom-away-from-classroom; and Email is your formal “official letter” sent at the speed of light — each tool has its own “etiquette” just like the writing types in Week 6/7 did.*

Microsoft Office Tools for Writing and Presentation

Tool	Used for
MS-Word	Word processing — documents, letters, reports, essays
MS-Excel	Spreadsheet software — data, tables, and calculations
MS-PowerPoint	Slide software — presentations
Corel Draw	Graphic design/illustration software — visual content

Social Media Applications for Lectures and Assessment

- WhatsApp and Telegram — messaging platforms used for class groups, sharing materials, and quick, informal communication
- Zoom and Google Meet — video conferencing platforms used for live, real-time virtual lectures and meetings

E-mail

- Definition — an electronic system for sending and receiving written messages over the internet
- Etiquette — the professional norms guiding proper email conduct
 - Composing E-mail — writing the message clearly and professionally, with a logical structure
 - Avoiding wrong/misleading address — double-checking the recipient's email before sending to avoid embarrassing or costly mistakes
 - Subject crafting — writing a clear, specific subject line that accurately reflects the content, so the recipient can prioritise it
 - Composing body of e-mail — structuring the message with a greeting, clear purpose, and organised points
 - Complimentary closure — a polite sign-off (e.g. “Best regards”) placed just before the sender's name
 - Attaching attachments — correctly attaching files and clearly referencing them in the body of the email
 - Formatting e-mails and fonts (Standard Format) — using a clean, readable, professional font/layout, avoiding overly decorative fonts/colours
 - Electronic signature — a standard sign-off block with the sender's name and contact details at the very end
 - Social Media Content Creation — producing clear, appropriate written/visual content suited to online platforms

EXAM HACK

In “which tool best fits this scenario” questions: live, face-to-face-style class = Zoom/Google Meet; quick group announcement = WhatsApp/Telegram; formal official communication with a paper trail = Email. For email etiquette MCQs, the wrong option is almost always the one skipping a clear **Subject line** or using an informal/incomplete **Electronic signature**.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. Which MS Office tool is used mainly for spreadsheets/calculations? (*Ans: MS-Excel*)
2. Which MS Office tool is used mainly for slide presentations? (*Ans: MS-PowerPoint*)
3. Which MS Office tool is used mainly for word processing? (*Ans: MS-Word*)
4. Which tool is used mainly for graphic design/illustration? (*Ans: Corel Draw*)
5. Which two apps are named for live video-conferencing lectures? (*Ans: Zoom and Google Meet*)
6. Which two apps are named for quick messaging/class groups? (*Ans: WhatsApp and Telegram*)
7. What does email etiquette govern? (*Ans: Proper, professional email conduct*)
8. What must be checked to avoid sending an email to the wrong person? (*Ans: The recipient's email address*)
9. What part of an email tells the recipient what it's about at a glance? (*Ans: The subject line*)
10. What is a polite sign-off phrase like "Best regards" called? (*Ans: Complimentary closure*)
11. What is the block with a sender's name/contact details at the end of an email called? (*Ans: Electronic signature*)
12. What should be avoided in email formatting/fonts, according to standard format? (*Ans: Overly decorative fonts/colours*)
13. Referencing and correctly attaching a file relates to which email element? (*Ans: Attaching attachments*)
14. For a formal official communication needing a paper trail, which tool is best? (*Ans: Email*)
15. For a quick group announcement to classmates, which tools are best? (*Ans: WhatsApp/Telegram*)
16. True or False: Email etiquette allows sending without double-checking the recipient address. (*Ans: False*)
17. Which section of the email includes a greeting and organised points? (*Ans: The body of the email*)
18. Name at least 3 of the specific email etiquette sub-skills listed. (*Ans: Any 3 of: composing, avoiding wrong address, subject crafting, composing body, complimentary closure, attaching attachments, formatting, electronic signature*)
19. Social Media Content Creation, in this context, is about producing what? (*Ans: Clear, appropriate written/visual content for online platforms*)
20. Which Office tool would you use to design a flyer for an event? (*Ans: Corel Draw*)

WEEK 13: PARTS OF SPEECH

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Parts of speech are like job roles at a wedding. The Noun is the bride/groom (the person/thing everything is about). The Pronoun is the stand-in when you don't want to keep repeating the bride's name. The Verb is the action happening (dancing, eating). The Adjective and Adverb are the decorators, describing how things/actions look. The Conjunction is the MC linking one event to the next. The Preposition tells you WHERE something is relative to something else. The Interjection is the crowd shouting "Wow!"

1. Nouns

- Proper Nouns — names of people, places, countries, months, days, geographical features, continents, etc.; they have SPECIFIC reference and are usually written with initial capitals. E.g. Kemi, Paul, September, Asia, Oye-Ekiti, Tuesday.
- Common Nouns — refer to objects/entities/places with a GENERAL reference (not one specific one). Split into two:
 - Concrete common nouns — nouns that can be seen or touched; tangible, physically exist. E.g. pot, fan, table, school, pens.
 - Abstract common nouns — cannot be seen or touched; non-material things like politics, ideas, state/situation, etc. E.g. joy, happiness, peace, beauty, kindness, love.
- Countable and Uncountable Nouns — Countable nouns can be counted/numbered because they have both singular and plural forms (e.g. table/tables, chair/chairs). Uncountable nouns cannot be counted because they are an undifferentiated mass — they do NOT take the 's' marker of plurality even when they express a plural sense (e.g. furniture, equipment, information, data, oil, water, courage stay the same in 'singular' and 'plural'). Uncountable nouns instead take MEASURES, e.g. a piece/pieces of information; a loaf/loaves of bread; a gallon/keg of oil/water.
- Collective Nouns — also called group nouns; provide a collective name for a group. E.g. a team of players, a bunch of keys, a pride of lions, a school of fishes, a bevy of ladies.

2. Pronouns

- A pronoun is used in place of a noun, usually to avoid unnecessary repetition. E.g. instead of "Ade bought a car and Ade got a driver because Ade couldn't drive a car," it should be written as "Ade bought a car and HE got a driver because HE couldn't drive a car."

	Subject	Object
1st person	I / We	Me / Us
2nd person	You	You
3rd person	He, She, It, They	Him, Her, It, Them

Types of Pronouns (8)

Type	Meaning/Examples
Personal	I, you, me, it, they, us, them
Possessive	Show ownership — my, mine, ours, yours, his, hers, theirs
Reciprocal	Refer from one person to another — each other, one another

Type	Meaning/Examples
Reflexive	Refer back to the person/group involved — himself, herself, oneself, themselves, itself
Relative	Introduce relative (adjectival) clauses — who, which, when, whose
Interrogative	Used to ask questions — who, where, what, whose, which
Demonstrative	This, these, that, those — check if they can be replaced with a noun to confirm they're pronouns here
Correlative	Neither...nor, either...or

3. Adjectives

- Adjectives provide additional information about a noun; they describe a noun.
- Adjectives can show DEGREES/grades: e.g. 'Tola is a tall boy' (base); 'Bolu is taller than Tola' (comparative).
- Degrees are realised from Base → Comparative → Superlative, using suffixes '-er/-est' or premodifiers 'more/most'.

Base	Comparative	Superlative
tall	taller (+er)	tallest (+est)
courageous	more courageous	most courageous
virtuous	more virtuous	most virtuous
generous	more generous	most generous
good (irregular)	better	best
bad (irregular)	worse	worst

- Adjectives ending in '-ous' (and similar longer adjectives) use premodifiers 'more/most' rather than the '-er/-est' suffix.
- Irregular adjectives like good/bad do NOT take the '-er/-est' suffixes, and do NOT take 'more/most' premodifiers either — they simply change form entirely (good→better→best; bad→worse→worst).

4. Verbs

- Verbs are action words; they indicate the action of a noun or pronoun. E.g. show, talk, walk.
- Lexical Verbs — can stand or make meaning on their own; do not depend on another word before being understood. E.g. dance, jump.
- Auxiliary Verbs ("Helping Verbs") — cannot stand on their own; used together with lexical verbs. Divided into two:
 - Modal Auxiliary — can, could, shall, should, may, might, must, ought to
 - Non-modal Auxiliary — three forms: Be (is, are, was, were, being); Have (has, have, had); Do (do, doing, done, did)
- Example: 'He danced' — lexical verb alone. 'He CAN dance' — CAN is the auxiliary verb, dance is the lexical verb.

The 5 Forms a Verb Takes

Form	Example
Base form	dance, sing, talk
-S form (present tense)	dances
Past tense	danced, sang
Past participle	sung, spoken
-ing form (continuous)	dancing, singing

- Regular Verbs — predictable, because their past tense and past participle are formed by adding ‘-ed’. E.g. bake, bakes, baked, baking.

- Irregular Verbs — do NOT take ‘-ed’ to form the past tense/participle. E.g. fall/falls/fell/fallen/falling; fight/fights/fought/fighting; kneel/kneels/knelt/kneeling.

- Finite Verbs — show tense, number, concord, and mood. E.g. ‘The man died’ (tense); ‘They ARE around’ is correct, ‘They IS around’ is wrong (number/concord).

- Non-finite Verbs — do NOT show tense, number, concord, or mood. E.g. ‘To err is human.’

5. Adverbs

- Adverbs are used to modify verbs. They show the degree or extent of the action expressed by a verb. Most adverbs end with ‘-ly’: quickly, slowly, strongly, intensely, passionately, completely, seriously, steadfastly, rightly.

- N/B: NOT all adverbs end with ‘-ly’ — e.g. ‘We can walk FAST’ (fast is already the adverb form; ‘He locked the bag fastly’ is WRONG, ‘fastly’ is not a real word).

6. Conjunctions

- Conjunctions are connectors. You use a conjunction to bring together words, phrases, and clauses. There are two types:

Type	Meaning — Examples
Co-ordinating conjunction	Links words/phrases/clauses of the SAME rank or equal level. There are three: and, but, or. E.g. ‘I am a boy AND she’s a girl.’ ‘Will you eat rice, beans OR garri.’
Subordinating conjunction	Introduces a clause that is subordinate to a main/super-ordinate clause. E.g. ‘ALTHOUGH she’s beautiful, she lacks manners.’ ‘WHEN it is raining, one needs an umbrella.’ ‘BECAUSE things are hard, he hasn’t been able to complete his house.’ ‘SINCE students resumed, school has been dirty.’

7. Prepositions

- A preposition is used to show a relationship between two nouns (or its equivalent) in a sentence. E.g. behind, under, over, above, below, through, against, among.

8. Interjections

- Interjections are used to express an outburst of feelings or emotions. These may be of surprise, delight, anger, pain, etc. E.g. Ouch!

Word Category Shift (same word, different part of speech)

- Many words change their part of speech depending on how they’re used in a sentence — and often shift STRESS/pronunciation too:

Word	As one part of speech	As another
Import	IM-port (noun) — 'Many Igbo businessmen import goods' shows import as a VERB here	im-PORT (verb) — the action of bringing goods in
Perfect	PER-fect (adjective) — 'He scored a perfect grade'	per-FECT (verb) — 'God should perfect his plan'
Invite / Invited	IN-vite (noun) — 'I got an invite to a party'	in-VITE-d (verb) — 'He invited people to his celebration'

EXAM HACK

For "identify the part of speech" questions: check what the word is **DOING** in that exact sentence, not what it usually is. A word after 'a/an/the' is almost always a **NOUN**; a word right after a subject doing an action is almost always a **VERB**. For pronoun types, if you can swap it for a name/thing and the sentence still works, it's a pronoun — the specific **TYPE** depends on its job (ownership=possessive, question=interrogative, points back to itself=reflexive).

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. 'Kemi' and 'September' are examples of which type of noun? (*Ans: Proper noun*)
2. 'Pot' and 'table' are examples of which type of common noun? (*Ans: Concrete common noun*)
3. 'Peace' and 'kindness' are examples of which type of common noun? (*Ans: Abstract common noun*)
4. Can uncountable nouns take the 's' marker of plurality? (*Ans: No*)
5. 'A team of players' is an example of which noun type? (*Ans: Collective noun*)
6. Which pronoun type shows ownership (my, mine, ours)? (*Ans: Possessive pronoun*)
7. Which pronoun type refers back to the subject (himself, itself)? (*Ans: Reflexive pronoun*)
8. Which pronoun type introduces a relative/adjectival clause (who, which)? (*Ans: Relative pronoun*)
9. 'Each other' and 'one another' are examples of which pronoun type? (*Ans: Reciprocal pronoun*)
10. How many degrees does an adjective have, and name them. (*Ans: Three: Base, Comparative, Superlative*)
11. Which suffixes mark comparative and superlative for short adjectives? (*Ans: -er and -est*)
12. Which premodifiers mark comparative/superlative for longer/-ous adjectives? (*Ans: more and most*)
13. What are the comparative and superlative of 'good'? (*Ans: better, best*)
14. Can a lexical verb stand alone and make meaning? (*Ans: Yes*)
15. Name the two types of Non-modal Auxiliary verb groups (3 words total). (*Ans: Be, Have, Do*)
16. Name any 3 Modal Auxiliary verbs. (*Ans: Any 3 of: can, could, shall, should, may, might, must, ought to*)
17. Do regular verbs form their past tense by adding '-ed'? (*Ans: Yes*)
18. Do finite verbs show tense, number, concord and mood? (*Ans: Yes*)
19. Do all adverbs end in '-ly'? (*Ans: No (e.g. 'fast')*)
20. What are the 2 types of conjunctions, and name the 3 co-ordinating ones? (*Ans: Co-ordinating and Subordinating; and, but, or*)

WEEK 14: SENTENCES

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

A sentence is like a full Jollof rice plate (a complete, unified meal/thought), while a clause is one ingredient group inside it. An Independent clause is a plate that's already complete on its own (rice alone is a full meal); a Dependent clause is like the stew — delicious, but it can't be served as 'the meal' by itself, it needs the rice to lean on.

Definition of a Sentence

- A sentence is a string of words that makes a complete and unified sense. A sentence can be composed of one or more clauses, where a clause is made up of at least a SUBJECT and a VERB. A sentence may contain at least one Independent clause, and one or more Dependent clauses.

Types of Clauses

Clause	Meaning
Independent clause (main clause)	A complete thought. It can stand on its own.
Dependent clause (subordinate clause)	Expresses an incomplete thought. It CANNOT stand on its own.

Categorisation of Sentences — (A) According to Structure

Sentence type	Structure	Example
Simple sentence	One Independent clause — a single thought	'Whales are mammals.' 'GST 102 classes are boring.'
Compound sentence	Two or more Independent clauses, linked by co-ordinating conjunctions (and, but, or) — more than one co-ordinating conjunction can be used	'He came to school and attended a number of classes but he didn't note any note.'
Complex sentence	One (or more) Independent clause + one (or more) Dependent clause, linked by a subordinating conjunction	'Student must attend classes BECAUSE classes are compulsory.' 'I will attend your party IF I am invited.'
Compound-Complex sentence	Combines the Complex sentence and the Compound sentence forms — contains two or more Independent clauses AND one or more Dependent clauses	'Teachers are interesting people AND they put in their best into their work BECAUSE they don't want their students to fail WHEN they have put in so many hours of teaching.' (2 Independent clauses linked by 'and'; 2 Dependent clauses linked by 'because' and 'when')

Categorisation of Sentences — (B) According to Function

- A sentence can communicate several functions, including:

Function	Meaning — Examples
Declarative	Realised as a STATEMENT. E.g. 'He is studying.' 'The book is mine.' 'The table is green.'
Imperative	A COMMAND. E.g. 'Stand up.' 'Get out.' 'Keep shut.' 'Stay silent.' A 'Command with Vocative' is when you include the person you're addressing, e.g. 'Tolu, should keep shut.'
Exclamatory	Shows feelings/emotions; usually marked with an exclamation mark (!). E.g. 'She is excited!!!' 'I am happy!!!'
Interrogative (standard 4th type)	Asks a QUESTION; marked with a question mark (?). E.g. 'Is the book yours?' (Note: your source material referenced 5 functional types but only 3 were legible in the uploaded pages — Interrogative is the well-established 4th type; double check with your lecturer for the 5th.)

EXAM HACK

Fast structural ID: count Independent clauses and Dependent clauses. 1 Independent + 0 Dependent = Simple. 2+ Independent + 0 Dependent = Compound. 1+ Independent + 1+ Dependent = Complex. 2+ Independent + 1+ Dependent = Compound-Complex. Spot Dependent clauses by their subordinating conjunction starter: although, when, because, since, if, while, unless, before, after.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What must a clause contain, at minimum? (Ans: A subject and a verb)
2. Can an independent clause stand on its own? (Ans: Yes)
3. Can a dependent clause stand on its own? (Ans: No)
4. How many independent clauses does a Simple sentence have? (Ans: One)
5. How many independent clauses does a Compound sentence have? (Ans: Two or more)
6. What links the clauses in a Compound sentence? (Ans: Co-ordinating conjunctions (and, but, or))
7. What does a Complex sentence contain, structurally? (Ans: At least one independent clause and one dependent clause)
8. What links a dependent clause to a main clause in a Complex sentence? (Ans: A subordinating conjunction)
9. Name 3 example subordinating conjunctions. (Ans: Any 3 of: although, when, because, since, if)
10. A Compound-Complex sentence combines which two sentence types? (Ans: Compound and Complex)
11. 'Whales are mammals' is which sentence type? (Ans: Simple sentence)
12. 'Student must attend classes because classes are compulsory' is which sentence type? (Ans: Complex sentence)
13. Which functional sentence type is realised as a statement? (Ans: Declarative)
14. Which functional sentence type is a command? (Ans: Imperative)
15. Which functional sentence type shows feelings/emotions with '!'? (Ans: Exclamatory)
16. What is it called when a command includes the name of the person addressed? (Ans: Command with Vocative)
17. 'Tolu, should keep shot' is an example of what? (Ans: Command with Vocative)
18. Can more than one co-ordinating conjunction be used in a single compound sentence? (Ans: Yes)
19. What mark typically signals an Exclamatory sentence? (Ans: The exclamation mark (!))
20. A sentence with 2 independent clauses linked by 'and' and 2 dependent clauses linked by 'because' and 'when' is which type? (Ans: Compound-Complex sentence)

WEEK 15: COMPREHENSION

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Comprehension is like detective work on a passage: you read it once for the 'big picture' (general idea), then again slowly with a magnifying glass (vocabulary/structure), break the case into smaller clues (sections), and only then go hunting for the exact answer to each question — in YOUR OWN words, never lifted straight from the text.

Definition

- To comprehend means to understand a particular text.

Purpose of Reading (for comprehension)

- To answer certain questions based on the passage
- To have an overall view of what the passage is all about
- To identify the main ideas or materials in a passage
- To grasp the details of the information given in a passage

To Understand a Comprehension, You Need to Know

- The significant ideas in a passage
- Whether they are presented in a significant order
- The reasons why they are presented in that order
- What relation exists between a fact and an idea
- Whether the relations are unrelated, or contradicting the facts and the ideas

Types of Comprehension Questions

Type	Meaning
Traditional Open-ended question (Essay type)	You are expected to give your answers in your OWN words
Multiple Choice question (Objectives)	Split into: Objective — options are made available; Subjective — options are NOT made available

Tips on How to Approach a Comprehension Passage

- Read the passage quickly to get the general idea
- Read the passage a second time, but slowly and more carefully, working out vocabulary and sentence structure as you go
- Divide the passage into smaller sections — it helps you understand what the writer is driving at
- Read the questions and note the specific requirement of each
- Search the passage for the answers
- Make sure your answers are in your OWN words — avoid lifting answers verbatim from the comprehension text
- Where asked to supply another word for a phrase, use ONLY a word — obey instructions

Things to Avoid While Answering Comprehension Questions

- Do not read the questions before reading the comprehension text

- Do not fail to understand a question before answering it
- If asked to supply a word for a phrase, just give a word — don't try to impress the examiner with more
- Do not overlook the instructions
- Avoid repetition of answers
- Avoid rigmarole/beating about the bush — go straight to the point

EXAM HACK

The examiner's #1 trap is answers lifted word-for-word from the passage — these are almost always marked down or rejected outright. ALWAYS restate the idea in your own words, even if the passage's wording feels perfect. Second trap: reading the questions BEFORE the passage feels efficient but primes you to misread the passage looking for 'expected' answers — read the passage twice FIRST.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What does 'to comprehend' mean? (Ans: *To understand a particular text*)
2. Name 2 of the 4 purposes of reading for comprehension. (Ans: *Any 2 of: answer questions, get overall view, identify main ideas, grasp details*)
3. What are the 2 types of comprehension questions? (Ans: *Traditional open-ended (essay type) and Multiple Choice (Objectives)*)
4. In Objective multiple choice, are options made available? (Ans: *Yes*)
5. In Subjective multiple choice, are options made available? (Ans: *No*)
6. Should you read the passage once or twice before answering questions? (Ans: *Twice*)
7. What should you focus on during the SECOND reading? (Ans: *Vocabulary and sentence structure*)
8. Why should you divide the passage into smaller sections? (Ans: *To understand what the writer is driving at*)
9. Should your answers be lifted directly from the passage? (Ans: *No — they should be in your own words*)
10. If asked to supply a word for a phrase, how many words should you give? (Ans: *Just one word*)
11. Should you read the questions before or after reading the passage? (Ans: *After*)
12. What should you avoid doing with your answers across the whole comprehension? (Ans: *Repetition*)
13. What phrase describes beating about the bush instead of going straight to the point? (Ans: *Rigmarole*)
14. Name one of the 5 things you need to know to understand a comprehension passage. (Ans: *Any 1 of: significant ideas, their order, reasons for the order, relation between fact and idea, whether relations are contradicting*)
15. True or False: You should always try to impress the examiner with long answers to word-supply questions. (Ans: *False*)
16. What is the main risk of not understanding a question before answering it? (Ans: *Answering incorrectly/off-target*)
17. Should you overlook instructions in a comprehension exercise? (Ans: *No*)
18. What kind of question type requires answers strictly in the student's own words? (Ans: *Traditional open-ended (essay type)*)
19. Reading the passage quickly the first time serves what purpose? (Ans: *To get the general idea*)
20. What must you always do before answering, according to the tips? (Ans: *Search the passage properly for the answers*)

WEEK 16: REGISTER

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Register is like your 'voice setting' — the same person talks differently to their boss (Formal register: sharp, no slang, professional) than to their best friend on WhatsApp (Informal register: slang, jokes, short broken sentences). Using the wrong 'voice setting' in the wrong context is a classic tone mismatch, and exams test whether you can spot which register a text belongs to.

Definition of Register

- Register can be defined as the extent of formality in a particular type of conversation or communication. Every communication has a pattern.

Types of Register

Type	Used in / Examples
Formal Register	Official, professional, or academic contexts — e.g. professional announcements & reports, business letters, academic essays, official speeches
Informal Register	Casual, familiar contexts — e.g. phone texts, letters to a friend, WhatsApp texts, personal short notes, personal e-mails, personal diaries

Rules Guiding the Use of Formal Register

- Avoid the use of slang
- Avoid the use of abbreviations or acronyms
- Do not begin sentences with words like 'But', 'And' — rather use words like 'Moreover', 'However', 'In addition'
- Avoid the use of contractions like 'can't', 'haven't' — write them in full
- Try to use more ACTIVE voice instead of PASSIVE voice. E.g. Passive: 'The food was eaten by her mum' (avoid); Active: 'Her mum ate the food' (preferred)

Informal Register

- Informal register accommodates slang, jokes, abbreviations, acronyms, and short/incomplete sentences — the exact opposite of what Formal register allows.

EXAM HACK

Fast register ID: slang/contractions/incomplete sentences = Informal. Full words, no contractions, active voice, no 'But/And' sentence starters = Formal. If a question shows a passive-voice sentence and asks you to 'correct it for formal register', the fix is almost always: flip it to active voice.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What does Register mean? (*Ans: The extent of formality in a particular type of communication*)
2. Name the 2 types of register. (*Ans: Formal and Informal*)
3. Is a business letter written in formal or informal register? (*Ans: Formal*)
4. Are WhatsApp texts written in formal or informal register? (*Ans: Informal*)
5. Should formal register use slang? (*Ans: No*)
6. Should formal register use abbreviations/acronyms? (*Ans: No*)
7. Which voice should formal register prefer — active or passive? (*Ans: Active voice*)
8. 'The food was eaten by her mum' is written in which voice? (*Ans: Passive voice*)
9. 'Her mum ate the food' is written in which voice? (*Ans: Active voice*)
10. Which voice does formal register recommend AVOIDING? (*Ans: Passive voice*)
11. Should sentences in formal register begin with 'But' or 'And'? (*Ans: No*)
12. Name a word that can replace starting a formal sentence with 'But'. (*Ans: However (or Moreover/In addition)*)
13. Should formal writing use contractions like 'can't'? (*Ans: No, write in full ('cannot')*)
14. Does informal register accommodate short/incomplete sentences? (*Ans: Yes*)
15. Does informal register accommodate jokes and slang? (*Ans: Yes*)
16. Are academic essays written in formal or informal register? (*Ans: Formal*)
17. Are personal diaries written in formal or informal register? (*Ans: Informal*)
18. True or False: Formal and informal register follow the exact same rules. (*Ans: False*)
19. Which register would a professional report use? (*Ans: Formal register*)
20. Which register would a personal short note to a friend use? (*Ans: Informal register*)

WEEK 17: THE FULL WRITING PROCESS & ACADEMIC WRITING STYLES

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Building an essay is like building a house: first you survey the land and gather materials (Pre-writing & Gathering Information), then you actually construct floor by floor — foundation, walls, roof (Introduction, Body, Conclusion) — and finally you don't add new rooms once you're painting the walls (the Conclusion should never introduce new material).

Purpose of Academic Writing

- The main purpose of academic writing is to INFORM. It does not entertain. It possesses a central line of thought, with all arguments channelled toward that particular line of thought.

Features of Academic Writing (expanded)

Feature	Meaning
Formality	The use of informal language is strictly prohibited
Precision	Requires specification — exact, specific detail rather than vague statements
Objectivity	The ability of the writer to present their idea, acknowledge everyone's idea, analyse it, and bring out their own view from it
Explicitness	Should be detailed, clear, and appropriately achieved; includes the ability to acknowledge what you read or gathered (i.e. proper citation)
Accuracy and Responsibility	You should be accurate and be able to be responsible for whatever you know — ready to take responsibility for whatever you write down

Academic Writing Styles (4)

Style	Meaning
Descriptive style	Purpose is to give out facts, especially those in sciences; the researcher is expected to report factually
Analytical style	Involves the comparison of two or more things
Persuasive style	Mostly used by all departments; seen in research articles. You should have convincing evidence for every claim, make sure your assumptions are valid, and present coherent arguments that will help people support your view
Critical style	A step further from persuasive writing; means your ability to debate, criticise, analyse, and disagree with other people's points of view

Writing Process / Stage of Development of Ideas

- Stage 1 — Pre-writing Stage:
 - You survey what you actually want to write, so you'll know the right thing to do

- Develop ideas by reading widely, even about subjects not currently being taught in class/lecture
- Interact with intellectual people — people who concentrate seriously on what they do
- Reflect periodically — after reading widely and interacting with people, sit back and reflect on what you've read
- Be conscious of your audience — every write-up has intended readers in mind; this helps you channel your write-up toward the lessons you want them to learn
- Brainstorm what you have learnt — discuss with others and brainstorm together
- Shaping information — gather all necessary information and put it down constructively; this is divided into 3 divisions: the Introduction, Body, and Conclusion
- Stage 2 — Gathering Information Stage: you go to the library, online, the web, etc., to search and brainstorm.
- Stage 3 — Building the Essay Draft Stage:
 - Introducing the essay — write something that will attract your audience
 - Body of the essay — be coherent; organise your work well; make use of linking words, e.g. moreover, however
 - Conclusion of the essay — bring together the most vital information in your writing and form it into one or two sentences

What the Conclusion Should Include

- The significance of your findings
- The implication of the conclusion
- A possible prediction about the future
- Your contribution/specific advice
- The limitation of the approach you took
- The conclusion is NOT expected to have any new material. When you're done with the work, sit down, review, and rewrite the work.

Things to Consider When Writing the Conclusion

- Recheck to be sure you haven't gone beyond the original scope of the work
- Read aloud slowly to trim your ideas and eliminate excess words
- Check for points that seem unclear and incomplete; be specific in what you are writing
- Give the piece of work to another person to make sure everything is correct, with no grammatical errors, and to make necessary corrections where necessary

EXAM HACK

Memorise the writing process order: **Pre-writing** → **Gathering Information** → **Drafting (Intro, Body, Conclusion)** → **Review/Rewrite**. For the 4 Academic Writing Styles, match the VERB in the question to the style: 'report facts' = Descriptive; 'compare' = Analytical; 'convince/argue' = Persuasive; 'critique/disagree' = Critical (the step BEYOND persuasive).

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What is the main purpose of academic writing? (*Ans: To inform*)
2. Does academic writing aim to entertain? (*Ans: No*)
3. Name the 4 Academic Writing Styles. (*Ans: Descriptive, Analytical, Persuasive, Critical*)
4. Which style involves comparing two or more things? (*Ans: Analytical style*)
5. Which style focuses on reporting facts, especially in sciences? (*Ans: Descriptive style*)
6. Which style requires convincing evidence and valid assumptions? (*Ans: Persuasive style*)
7. Which style is described as 'a step further from persuasive writing'? (*Ans: Critical style*)
8. What is the first stage of the writing process (idea development)? (*Ans: Pre-writing stage*)
9. What is the second stage of the writing process? (*Ans: Gathering Information stage*)
10. What is the third stage of the writing process? (*Ans: Building the Essay Draft stage*)
11. Into what 3 divisions is 'shaping information' split? (*Ans: Introduction, Body, Conclusion*)
12. Should the conclusion contain new material? (*Ans: No*)
13. Name 2 of the 5 things a conclusion should include. (*Ans: Any 2 of: significance of findings, implication of conclusion, prediction about the future, contribution/advice, limitation of approach*)
14. What should you do after finishing a piece of work, before submitting? (*Ans: Review and rewrite it*)
15. Why should you read your conclusion aloud slowly? (*Ans: To trim ideas and eliminate excess words*)
16. Why should you give your work to another person before submitting? (*Ans: To check correctness and catch grammatical errors*)
17. What does 'being conscious of your audience' mean in pre-writing? (*Ans: Keeping your intended readers in mind to channel your write-up appropriately*)
18. What example linking words help organise the body of an essay? (*Ans: Moreover, however (or similar)*)
19. Objectivity in academic writing includes the ability to do what with others' ideas? (*Ans: Acknowledge, analyse, and bring out your own view from them*)
20. True or False: Precision in academic writing means being vague to stay safe. (*Ans: False (it means being specific)*)

WEEK 18: E-MAIL ETIQUETTE (EXTENDED)

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Extended email etiquette is like the difference between shouting across a market stall and speaking calmly at a bank counter. Typing in ALL CAPS online is read as SHOUTING/insults, over-punctuating!!!! feels unprofessional, and skipping a proper greeting feels rude — the small manners matter as much as the message itself.

Definition

- E-mail etiquette refers to the socially acceptable way of doing things — a set of customs/rules for polite behaviour, especially among a particular class of people. It matters because, for some people, email is their ONLY form of communication for certain purposes.

What Email Etiquette Includes (10 points)

#	Rule
1	Address the recipient properly
2	You are permitted to use a recipient's first name only if you are familiar with the person, or the person sends you a message using just their first name
3	Do not assume any short form of a name for anybody
4	Be sure the length of the message is appropriate — not too long or too short
5	Capture the appropriate subject line
6	Keep the tone of the message accommodating — do not be too harsh; salutations like 'Hello, I hope you had a good day?' go a long way in building a good business relationship
7	Avoid the use of ALL CAPITAL LETTERS in your messages — they are socially considered as yelling/insults
8	Do not use abbreviations for professional emails
9	Avoid the use of over-punctuation (e.g. '!!!!') — it is considered unprofessional
10	Remember to proofread before sending the message

EXAM HACK

Exam trap: questions often describe an email using ALL CAPS or heavy punctuation ('Please reply ASAP!!!!') and ask what's wrong with it. The answer is almost always rule 7 (all caps = shouting/insult) or rule 9 (over-punctuation = unprofessional) — NOT about the content/subject matter.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. What does email etiquette refer to? (*Ans: The socially acceptable way of doing things in email communication*)
2. When are you permitted to use a recipient's first name? (*Ans: Only if you're familiar with them, or they used just their first name with you*)
3. Should you assume a short form of someone's name? (*Ans: No*)
4. Should an email message be too long or too short? (*Ans: Neither — it should be an appropriate length*)
5. What email element tells the reader what the message is about, at a glance? (*Ans: The subject line*)
6. How is typing in ALL CAPITAL LETTERS socially perceived in email? (*Ans: As yelling/insults*)
7. Should abbreviations be used in professional emails? (*Ans: No*)
8. How is over-punctuation (e.g. '!!!!') perceived in professional email? (*Ans: As unprofessional*)
9. What should you do right before sending a message? (*Ans: Proofread it*)
10. Give an example of a friendly, accommodating email salutation. (*Ans: 'Hello, I hope you had a good day?'*)
11. Should the tone of an email be harsh? (*Ans: No, it should be accommodating*)
12. What is one reason email etiquette matters so much for some people? (*Ans: It may be their only form of communication for certain purposes*)
13. List any 3 of the 10 email etiquette points. (*Ans: Any 3 from the 10-point list*)
14. Is using all caps considered acceptable for emphasis in professional email? (*Ans: No*)
15. True or False: A recipient's name can always be shortened for friendliness. (*Ans: False*)
16. What rule governs choosing an accommodating vs harsh tone? (*Ans: Rule 6 (keep tone accommodating)*)
17. Which rule specifically addresses message length? (*Ans: Rule 4*)
18. Which rule addresses proper subject-line use? (*Ans: Rule 5*)
19. Which two rules (7 and 9) both relate to how a message LOOKS rather than what it says? (*Ans: All caps usage and over-punctuation*)
20. What is the final email etiquette step before hitting send? (*Ans: Proofreading*)

BONUS: CONCORD (SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT)

ALZHEIMER'S MODE

Concord is just “matching.” Like matching your shoes to your belt — a singular subject must wear a singular verb, and a plural subject must wear a plural verb. Wear the wrong size and it looks (and sounds) wrong immediately: “He go” vs “He goes” — your ear already knows one is mismatched, even before you know the grammar rule behind why.

Definition of Concord

- Concord (agreement) is the grammatical rule requiring a subject and its verb (and related pronouns/determiners) to match/respond in number (singular or plural) and person (1st, 2nd, 3rd).
- Getting concord wrong is one of the most common grammar errors in spoken and written English, which is exactly why exams test it so heavily — the rules feel simple individually, but combine into many traps.

Types of Concord

Type	Meaning
Grammatical/Formal Concord	Agreement based strictly on the grammatical FORM of the subject (singular form → singular verb), regardless of meaning
Notional Concord	Agreement based on the MEANING/sense of the subject rather than its strict grammatical form (e.g. a collective noun treated as plural when its members are seen as acting individually)
Concord of Proximity	The verb agrees with whichever noun is NEAREST to it, especially with “or/nor” subjects (e.g. “Neither the teacher nor the students were happy” — verb matches “students”, the nearer noun)

Core Subject-Verb Agreement Rules

Rule	Example
A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb	She writes well. / They write well.
Two subjects joined by “and” take a plural verb	Musa and Ada are in class.
Two singular subjects joined by “and” referring to ONE person/idea take a singular verb	The secretary and treasurer (one person) is here.
Subjects joined by “as well as, together with, along with, in addition to, with” — verb agrees with the FIRST subject only	The teacher, as well as the students, was present.
Subjects joined by “or/nor, either...or, neither...nor” — verb agrees with the nearer subject	Neither the boys nor the girl was ready. / Neither the girl nor the boys were ready.
Collective nouns (team, family, government, jury, class) take a SINGULAR verb when acting as one unit, PLURAL when members act individually	The team is playing well (as a unit). / The team are arguing among themselves (individually).

Rule	Example
Indefinite pronouns (each, every, either, neither, everyone, everybody, somebody, no one, anybody) take a SINGULAR verb	Everyone is ready. Each of the students has a book.
“Each/Every” before a compound subject still takes a singular verb	Every boy and girl was rewarded.
“A number of” takes a PLURAL verb; “The number of” takes a SINGULAR verb	A number of students were absent. / The number of students was small.
Titles of books, names of countries, and single quoted words are treated as SINGULAR even if plural in form	“Things Fall Apart” is a great novel. The Netherlands is in Europe.
Sums of money, distances, periods of time, and quantities are treated as SINGULAR when seen as one unit	Five thousand naira is not enough. Ten kilometres is a long walk.
“None” can take a singular or plural verb depending on meaning (singular when emphasising “not one”)	None of the students has finished (emphasising individually) / None of the students have finished (general).
A relative pronoun (who/which/that) takes a verb that agrees with its antecedent	He is one of the boys who ARE always late.
Subjects separated from the verb by a phrase/clause still agree with the TRUE subject, not the nearest noun	The box of apples IS on the table (subject = box, not apples).
“Either” and “neither” used alone (as pronouns) take a singular verb	Either of the answers is correct.
Percentages/fractions agree with the noun that follows “of”	Fifty percent of the work is done. / Fifty percent of the students are absent.
“There is/There are” agrees with the noun that follows it, not with “there”	There is a book on the table. / There are books on the table.

EXAM HACK

The No.1 concord trap in exams is a long phrase sitting between the subject and the verb (“The quality of these goods ____ poor”). Cross out everything between commas/prepositional phrases and find the REAL subject first — here it’s “quality” (singular), not “goods,” so the answer is “is,” not “are.” Also memorise: **and** = plural (two things); **as well as / with / together with** = ignore it, look at subject 1 only; **or / nor** = look at the subject NEAREST the verb.

20 TRAP QUESTIONS — CLEAR THESE BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

1. "Musa and Ada ____ in class" — is/are? (*Ans: are*)
2. "The secretary and treasurer (one person) ____ here" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
3. "The teacher, as well as the students, ____ present" — was/were? (*Ans: was*)
4. "Neither the boys nor the girl ____ ready" — was/were? (*Ans: was*)
5. "The team ____ arguing among themselves" (individually) — is/are? (*Ans: are*)
6. "Everyone ____ ready" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
7. "Every boy and girl ____ rewarded" — was/were? (*Ans: was*)
8. "A number of students ____ absent" — was/were? (*Ans: were*)
9. "The number of students ____ small" — was/were? (*Ans: was*)
10. "'Things Fall Apart' ____ a great novel" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
11. "Ten kilometres ____ a long walk" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
12. "The box of apples ____ on the table" — is/are? (true subject = box) (*Ans: is*)
13. "Either of the answers ____ correct" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
14. "Fifty percent of the students ____ absent" — is/are? (*Ans: are*)
15. "There ____ a book on the table" — is/are? (*Ans: is*)
16. "There ____ books on the table" — is/are? (*Ans: are*)
17. "He is one of the boys who ____ always late" — is/are? (*Ans: are*)
18. Which concord type has the verb agreeing with the NEAREST noun? (*Ans: Concord of Proximity*)
19. Which concord type is based on strict grammatical FORM, not meaning? (*Ans: Grammatical/Formal Concord*)
20. "None of the students ____ finished" (emphasising not a single one) — has/have? (*Ans: has*)